SOFTWARE ARCHITECTURE & CONSULTING DEPARTMENT

Client Discovery Questionnaire

Stage 02 interview and information-gathering template

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Appendix C: Client Discovery Questionnaire

Send before the first interview; complete together. Record who answered, the date, and tag each answer **C / A / U**. Ask for documents where answers exist.

Client / respondent	
Role	
Interviewer / scribe	
Date	

1. Organisation and objectives

#	Question	Answer	C/A/U
1	What does the organisation do, and how does it make money or deliver value?		
2	What are the top three business objectives for the next 12-24 months?		
3	How will success of this project be measured (numbers)?		
4	Who is the executive sponsor and who makes the final decision?		
5	What happens if nothing changes?		

2. Stakeholders and process

#	Question	Answer	C/A/U
1	Who uses the system today (roles, count)? Who will be affected by change?		
2	Which business processes does it support? Where are manual steps or workarounds?		
3	What are the busiest periods (daily, monthly, seasonal)?		

3. Current systems

#	Question	Answer	C/A/U
1	List applications, owners, technologies and versions. Which are vendor-supported?		
2	Which systems exchange data? How (files, API, manual re-keying)?		
3	Where is it hosted (own premises, data centre, cloud)? Who administers it?		
4	Which databases and data volumes exist? How is data backed up and has restore been tested?		
5	What documentation exists and how current is it?		

4. Pain points and incidents

#	Question	Answer	C/A/U
1	What are the top five technical problems? Which cost money or customers?		
2	Recent outages or security incidents: dates, causes, impact?		
3	How long does a release take? How often do releases fail?		

5. Requirements and quality

#	Question	Answer	C/A/U
1	What must the new/changed system do that it cannot now?		
2	Expected users and transactions (today, in 3 years)?		
3	Acceptable downtime and data loss? Response-time expectations?		
4	Which data is personal, financial or confidential?		

6. Security and compliance

#	Question	Answer	C/A/U
1	Which laws, standards or customer audits apply (e.g. data-protection law, ISO/IEC 27001, PCI DSS)?		
2	How are users authenticated and authorised? Is multi-factor authentication used?		
3	Any previous security assessments or penetration tests?		

7. Team, skills and operations

#	Question	Answer	C/A/U
1	Size and skills of in-house IT/development team? Who is on call?		
2	Preferred technologies and any prohibited ones?		
3	Who will operate the solution after delivery?		

8. Budget, timeline and constraints

#	Question	Answer	C/A/U
1	Budget range and funding approval process?		
2	Hard dates (events, contracts, regulations)?		
3	Procurement or vendor constraints (existing licences, cloud agreements)?		

9. Risks and expectations

#	Question	Answer	C/A/U
1	What worries you most about this project?		
2	What has been tried before and why did it fail?		
3	What would make you call this engagement a success?		

CONFIDENTIALITY

Information in this questionnaire is confidential and used only for the engagement under the signed NDA. Do not paste client answers into public tools.